

Why Is Your Visa Still In Process?

Waiting for a visa can be stressful when your plans to travel, work, study or relocate depend upon receiving it. Many applicants only see “**In Process**” after checking their status each day but don’t understand what that means and why it is sometimes taking longer than expected.

Visa applications go through a **number of different stages** before being approved, and even if your application is complete with all **supporting documents submitted correctly**, officials in the immigration department still have to complete a series of processes to verify the information provided, determine eligibility and conduct internal checks. **The length of this process will vary depending on what country you are applying to and what type of visa you are attempting to get.** Each will have a unique processing time that can take between days and several months to complete.

A **high volume of applications is one of the most common reasons for delays.** During major holidays, intake periods between universities and large international events, thousands of applications come to the embassy or immigration office. This naturally will increase your processing times, even on simple cases.

Another large reason is **due to document verification.** Immigration agencies can contact your employer, financial institution, university, or sponsor in order to verify the documents you submitted to them to determine if they are legitimate or not. If there are any anomalies in information such as your salary, passport number, or travel history, your application may go into additional review.

Reasons for delays in **processing applications often relate to missing or unclear documents.** Small issues can create delays; for example, an illegible copy of a passport, an error or missing information on an application form or an expired supporting document. In some situations, an immigration department may request additional information prior to making a final decision on a case as well.

In addition to documentation issues, **background checks and security checks cause delays.** Most countries conduct security checks of all applicants. When an applicant has travelled extensively, has multiple visas, or has travelled to numerous different countries, the case is often subject to increased scrutiny and may take longer than usual to process. This does not necessarily mean that the application is going to be denied. It simply means that there is a lot of information to be verified for the application to be approved.

Processing delays can occur for a variety of reasons. **Technical and administrative delays include instances such as government technology malfunctioning, delays in staffing at embassies, public holidays, and changing federal policies.** In some countries, users submit an application to more than one office; these cases typically have longer processing times than single-office applications.

Many applicants believe they should make **multiple enquiries about their application or re-apply for an application while their original application is still being processed**. Most of the time, this creates confusion and results in further delays in processing an application. Most applicants should wait for confirmation of the official processing timeframe from the immigration authority before proceeding in any manner.

What to do when the Visa is still being processed?

Be sure to **frequently check your email and application portal for updates as well as any requests for additional documentation throughout the period until your visa has been approved**. Make certain that you continue to have an active telephone number and continue to receive contact via the telephone. **Avoid booking non-refundable travel arrangements, including airfares, hotels or other travel arrangements, until your visa has been approved**.

Most importantly, stay patient. **A delay in processing does not mean that your application will be denied**. Many times, the application will simply take longer than expected to be verified and obtain the required approvals internally.

Visa processing is usually not done instantly, and all applications are different, which makes it difficult to predict how long it may take to process each application. Although the wait may be frustrating, understanding the reasons behind the delay may help you to feel less anxious during the time period of waiting for your visa's issuance, help you understand the reason(s) for the delay and enable you to plan for what you will do when the visa has been issued.